RICHARD WAWERU MAINA
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product professional with experience leading early-stage discovery, defining MVP scope, and improving systems through data-driven iteration. Combines strong user empathy with technical literacy and clear communication. Comfortable operating in ambiguity, learning quickly, and taking ownership. Seeking PM roles focused on real user problems and measurable iteration.

EDUCATION

Minerva University — B.S. Computational Sciences & Economics | 2020 – 2024

PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

Sawalands — Founder & Product Owner | Remote | Apr 2025 – Jun 2025

- Identified $2B market opportunity through 25+ customer interviews with Kenyan land buyers, uncovering 40–60 day coordination delays and 15–20% transaction failure rates in group purchase process.
- Defined product vision and phased MVP roadmap for digital platform, prioritizing features by user value and delivery feasibility using RICE framework.
- Designed operational workflows for buyer coordination, document management, and payment tracking, informed by regulatory research across 3 counties.
- Produced product requirements documentation including user stories, success metrics (transaction completion rate, time-to-close), and MVP scope for potential development.

Roommate Organizer Platform — Product Lead | Minerva University | Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

- Led product development of residential coordination tool over 14 weeks, owning strategy and hands-on implementation for 4-person team.
- Conducted 20 user interviews discovering 80% struggled with maintenance tracking and 65% cited communication breakdowns; translated insights into prioritized MVP requirements using MoSCoW method.
- Ran 3 rounds of user testing with 15 participants, improving System Usability Scale scores from 60 to 82 through iterative feature refinement.
- Contributed 40% of codebase using Python/Flask and JavaScript/HTML/CSS for authentication, announcements, and issue tracking features.

PRODUCT-RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Covenant Prep — Learning Systems Designer | Hartford, CT | Sept 2024 – Dec 2025

● Designed 150+ learning experiences with clear success criteria for 100+ students, achieving 85% mastery rate on quarterly standards-based assessments.
● Implemented daily feedback loops collecting 400+ data points weekly to identify friction points and iterate on experience design, improving week-over-week performance by 20%.

FreezeCrowd — Marketing & Growth Associate | New York, NY | Jun 2022 – Sept 2022

● Analyzed onboarding funnel data from 1,000+ sessions to identify 3 major drop-off points causing 35% user abandonment.
● Executed 20+ A/B tests on messaging and landing pages, achieving 40% conversion rate (8% above benchmark).

SKILLS & TOOLS

PM: Discovery interviews, Requirements (user stories/acceptance criteria), User journeys, MVP scoping, Prioritization (RICE, MoSCoW), A/B testing, Metrics definition.
Technical: Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL, Git, API concepts, Excel/Sheets, Basic statistics.
Tools: Notion, Trello, Asana, Jira (familiar), Figma (basic), Google Analytics, Miro, Loom.
Languages: English, Swahili.